

about **gender** or instead feeds into the **oppression** of women in a patriarchal society.

- hooks' position that feminism is a struggle to end sexist/patriarchal oppression can be used to ask whether the video is part of that struggle or part of the oppression. Is Beyoncé adopting **feminism** as a lifestyle choice to sell music or has she made a political commitment to feminism? Again, this debate should take in the contrasting and possibly contradictory representations within the video.

Theories of ethnicity and postcolonial theory – Paul Gilroy

- Explore the music video in terms of **racial hierarchies** and binary **opposition** based on otherness.
- Consider ways in which the music video challenges racial hierarchy by **subverting expectations** and placing a black woman in a position of power and dominion, but may perpetuate a sense of binary opposition between races by perpetuating Gilroy's sense of '**otherness**' and a clear divide based on racial lines.